NORTHWESTERN DRUMLINE

2026 Audition Packet

Dear Percussionists,

We're so glad to hear that you're interested in the Northwestern University Drumline! We are a proud section of the Northwestern University Wildcat Marching Band, dedicated to sharing precision and musicianship with the Big Ten community and beyond. In addition, the NU Drumline is a large, close-knit group of friends brought together by their love of performance, rhythm, and marching percussion. Members come from a wide variety of backgrounds and experiences, so all the members of the line learn a great deal from each other as musicians and individuals. Each person is very dedicated to the group, and we can all testify that being a part of the NU Drumline is an invaluable and rewarding experience. Here's a brief introduction to our leadership team:

Scott Simon (Instructor) will be completing his seventh full season with NUMB and is excited to be a part of the team. His marching experience started in 1996 and continued for 8 seasons of drum corps, most notably with Phantom Regiment Drum and Bugle Corps for the 2000, 2002, and 2003 seasons. He then became a part of the instructional staff with Phantom from 2007-2010, as well as Santa Clara Vanguard in 2011 & 2017. Most recently, he served as a tenor tech for the Cavaliers from 2020-2023. Scott also teaches private lessons as well as the percussion class for Evanston Township High School. In addition to his teaching, he is very active in the musical theatre scene, playing drums and percussion for numerous productions in the Chicagoland area. Scott received his Master's in Music Performance from Central Michigan University and his Bachelor's from Illinois State.

Benjamin Lin (Co-Captain) is a senior from Edmond, Oklahoma, studying Statistics and Economics. This season will be his fourth on the line and fourth playing the snare drum. While not doing marching band things, Ben enjoys fishing, basketball, and playing in the Concert Band. This is his second year as drumline co-captain, and he is excited to run it back in a shiny, brand-new stadium!

Ethan Ro (Co-Captain) is a junior from Suwanee, Georgia, studying Physics, Neuroscience, and ISP. This will be his third year on the line and third year playing snare drum. In addition to marching band, Ethan loves staying active and is involved in Astrophysics Research and the Northwestern Emergency Medicine Organization. This will be his first year as drumline co-captain, and he is excited to work with everyone to create sick beats!

Jimmy Zhang (Co-Captain) is a senior from Hoffman Estates, Illinois, studying Data Science, ISP, and Math. This will be his fourth year on the line, and he has played tenors for the past two seasons. Outside of marching band, Jimmy is a big Chicago sports fan and conducts research with the Center for Network Dynamics. This will be his second year as drumline co-captain, and he is excited to have a great final season with NUMB!

We're all very excited to begin preparing for the 2026 season! Please read the instructions and music carefully, and don't hesitate to email with any questions. You can audition for as many or as few instruments as you'd like, but ***please audition for all instruments for which you would like to be considered***. Important: Please send us your summer mailing address (including effective dates), phone number, and email addresses (see contact information below).

Best Regards and Go 'Cats!

Benjamin Lin (405-738-2745) (BenjaminLin2027@u.northwestern.edu),
Ethan Ro (678-615-0342) (EthanRo2028@u.northwestern.edu),
Jimmy Zhang (224-875-8465) (JimmyZhang2027@u.northwestern.edu)

On-Campus Workshops and Audition

We are excited to continue this year with our on-campus audition model. During the month of May, two optional workshops will be held prior to the audition. These workshops will be led by Scott and will focus on fundamentals, audition materials, and cadences. These will be followed by the in-person audition on May 22. The details are listed below:

Workshop #1: Friday, May 1, 2026, 7:00-9:00 PM
Workshop #2: Friday, May 8, 2026, 7:00-9:00 PM
On-Campus Audition: Friday, May 22, 2026, 7:00-9:00 PM

The workshops and the on-campus audition will be held in Regenstein Hall of Music, Room 011.

Video Auditions

If you live a distance from campus that prevents you from participating in the on-campus audition date or are otherwise unable to attend the on-campus audition session, a video of your audition will be accepted. All video applicants should review the requirements below before submitting a video audition:

- The video should be posted unlisted on YouTube, with the link sent to scottia523@gmail.com. For full consideration with regard to part assignments on the line, submit your video by **Friday, June 19, 2026 at 11:59 PM CST**. However, we will continue to accept videos beyond this date, if necessary.
- Mark time during all parts of the audition. This means to "march in place." Stand with your feet together and parallel. Starting with the left foot on beat 1 of every measure (in standard 4/4 time), lift the foot about an inch and press it into the ground on each count. The ability to mark time while playing is an important component of the audition for all instruments.
- Please perform all exercises/etudes/cadence excerpts with an **audible metronome** in your video.
- Unless otherwise specified, please perform all exercises/etudes/ cadence excerpts two times.
- Videos must show your **entire body** and the instrument. Please make sure that we can see your feet in the video.
- Please announce your name at the beginning of the tape.

Instrument Instructions

- **Snare Drum:** The Northwestern Snareline uses traditional grip, so please use it in your audition. Please prepare the following exercises at the following tempo markings:

  - 8's – 144 bpm
  - Bucks – 136 bpm
  - Double/Triple Beat – 120 bpm
  - Gallop – 152 bpm
  - Triplet Diddle – 132 bpm
  - Flam exercises – 132 bpm
  - Stick Control – 120 bpm
  - Traditional m. 5-23 – 120 bpm

  Video auditions: If you own or can obtain a snare drum for the audition, please perform on it. If not, a practice pad will be suitable. Record the video in the order listed above at the indicated tempos.

- **Tenor Drums:** Play exercises with written arounds twice. The first time, play the snare drum part on drum 2, and the second time, play the tenor arounds. Please prepare the following exercises at the following tempo markings:

  - 8's – 144 bpm
  - Bucks – 136 bpm
  - Double/Triple Beat – 120 bpm
  - Gallop – 152 bpm
  - Triplet Diddle – 132 bpm
  - Flam exercises – 132 bpm
  - Stick Control – 120 bpm
  - Traditional m. 5-23 – 120 bpm

  Video auditions: If you own or can obtain tenor drums or a tenor practice pad, please perform on it. If not, please play matched grip on a snare drum pad. Record the video in the order listed above at the indicated tempos.

- **Bass Drum:** Play exercises with written splits twice–the first time with unisons (play snare line for Stick Control) and the second time with the split of the bass drum you would like to be placed on, if applicable. For Traditional, only play the split of the bass drum you would like to be placed on. Please prepare the following exercises at the following tempo markings:

  - 8's – 144 bpm
  - Bucks – 136 bpm
  - NU 16th-Note Timing – 132 bpm
  - Double/Triple Beat – 120 bpm
  - Gallop – 152 bpm
  - Stick Control – 120 bpm
  - Traditional m. 5-23 – 120 bpm

  Video auditions: If you own or can obtain a bass drum or a bass drum practice pad, please perform on it. If not, please play matched grip on a snare drum pad. Record the video in the order listed above at the indicated tempos.

- **Cymbals:** Measures with split stems are split A/B with note stems up 'a' and note stems down 'b'. Notes on the unison line with consistent stems are unison. For exercises with splits, only play one split part (along with unisons). Please prepare the following exercises at the following tempo markings:

  - Stick Control – 120 bpm
  - Clave – 120 bpm
  - Traditional m. 5-23 – 120 bpm

  Video auditions: If you own or can obtain a pair of cymbals, please perform with them. If not, please clap the exercises while marking time. Record the video in the order listed above at the indicated tempos.

Northwestern University Marching Band 2026
Drumline
Auditioner's Information Sheet

Video auditions: Please email this document with your video link.

Name: _____ Graduation Year: _____

Instrument(s): _____ Age: _____

Major: _____

Address: _____

Hometown: _____

Email: _____ Phone: _____

List order of instrument preference here:

Drumline Rehearsal Schedule:
M/W/F 4:00-6:00, T/Th 7:00-9:00
List any conflicts (even potential) you may have:

Previous Musical Experience:

Marching Band # of years: _____

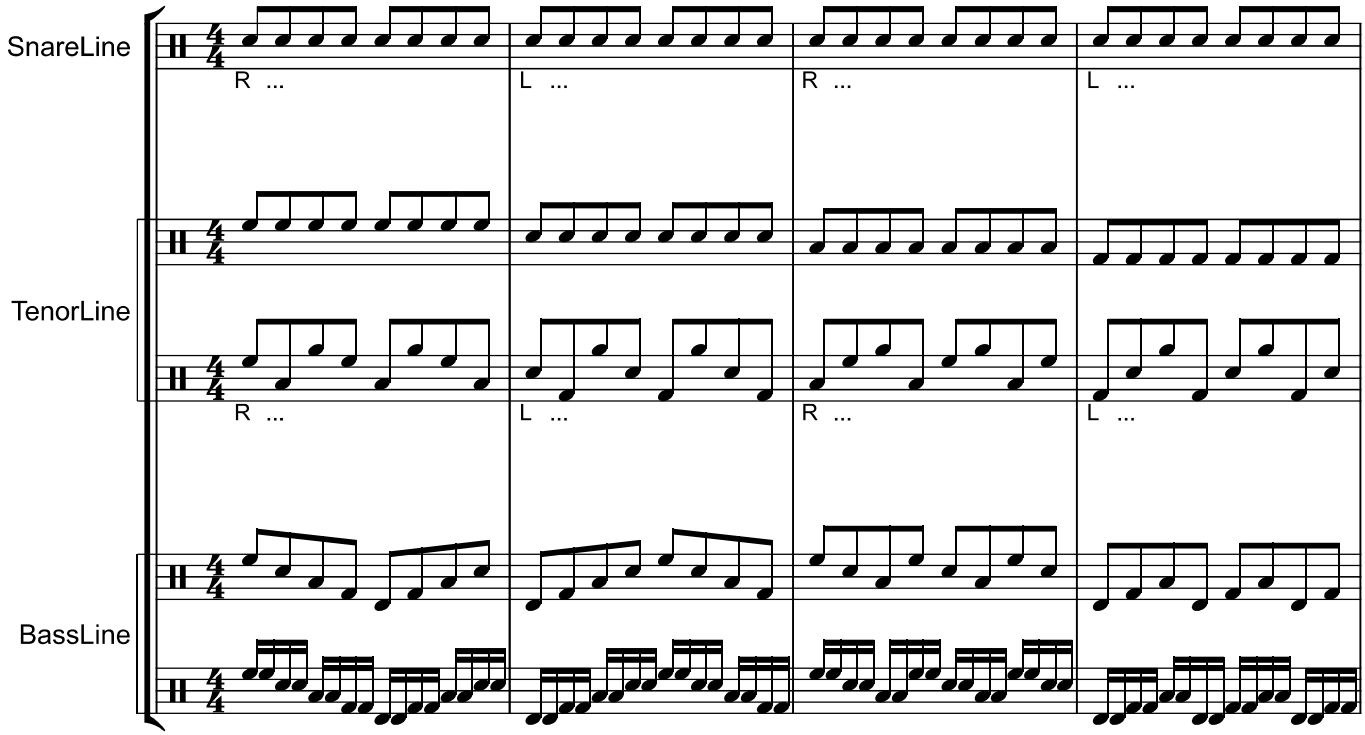
Concert Band # of years: _____

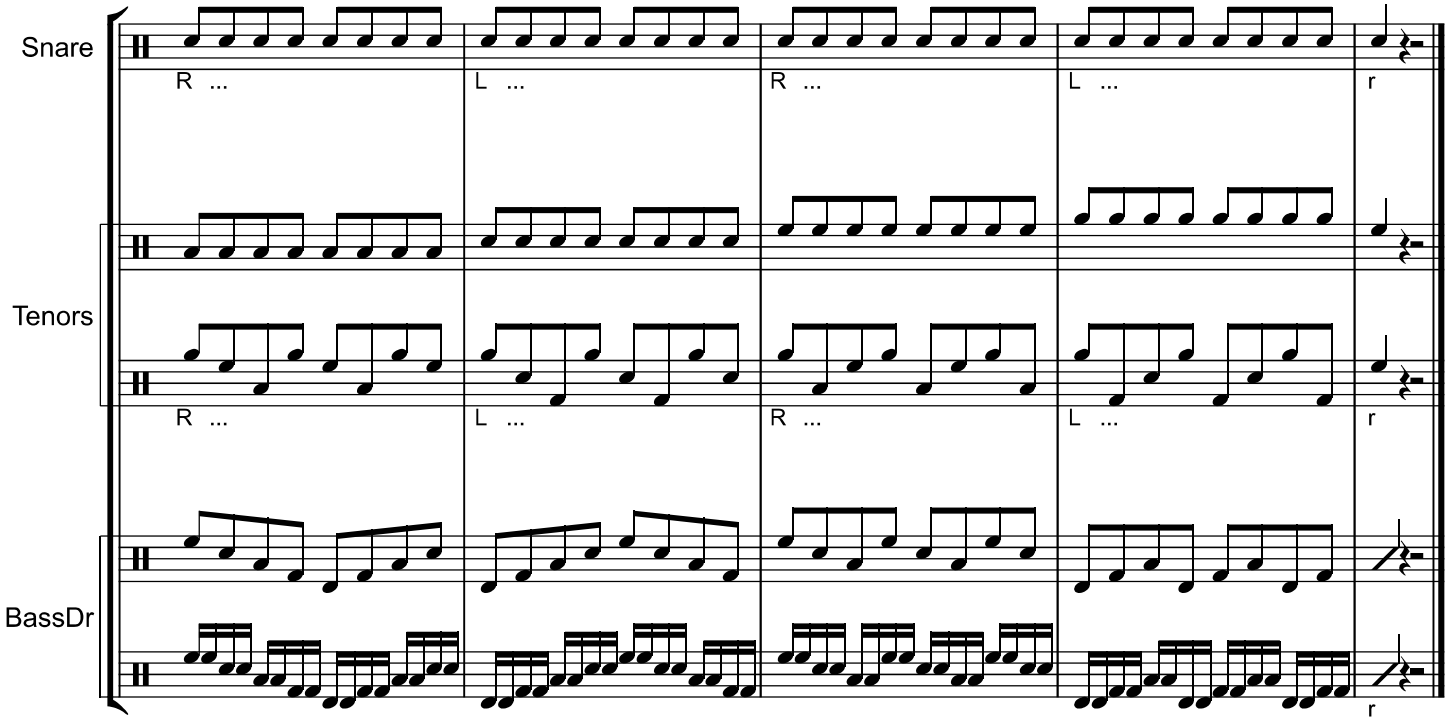
Orchestra # of years: _____

Jazz Band # of years: _____

Other: _____

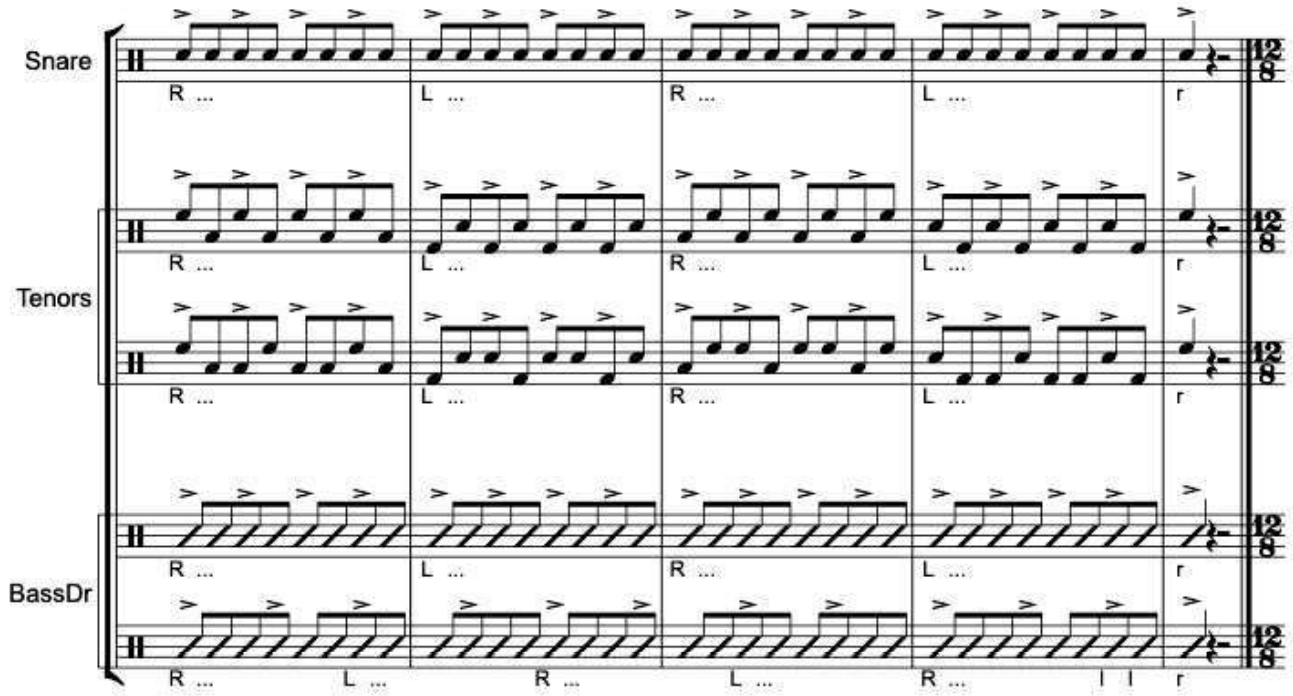
8's



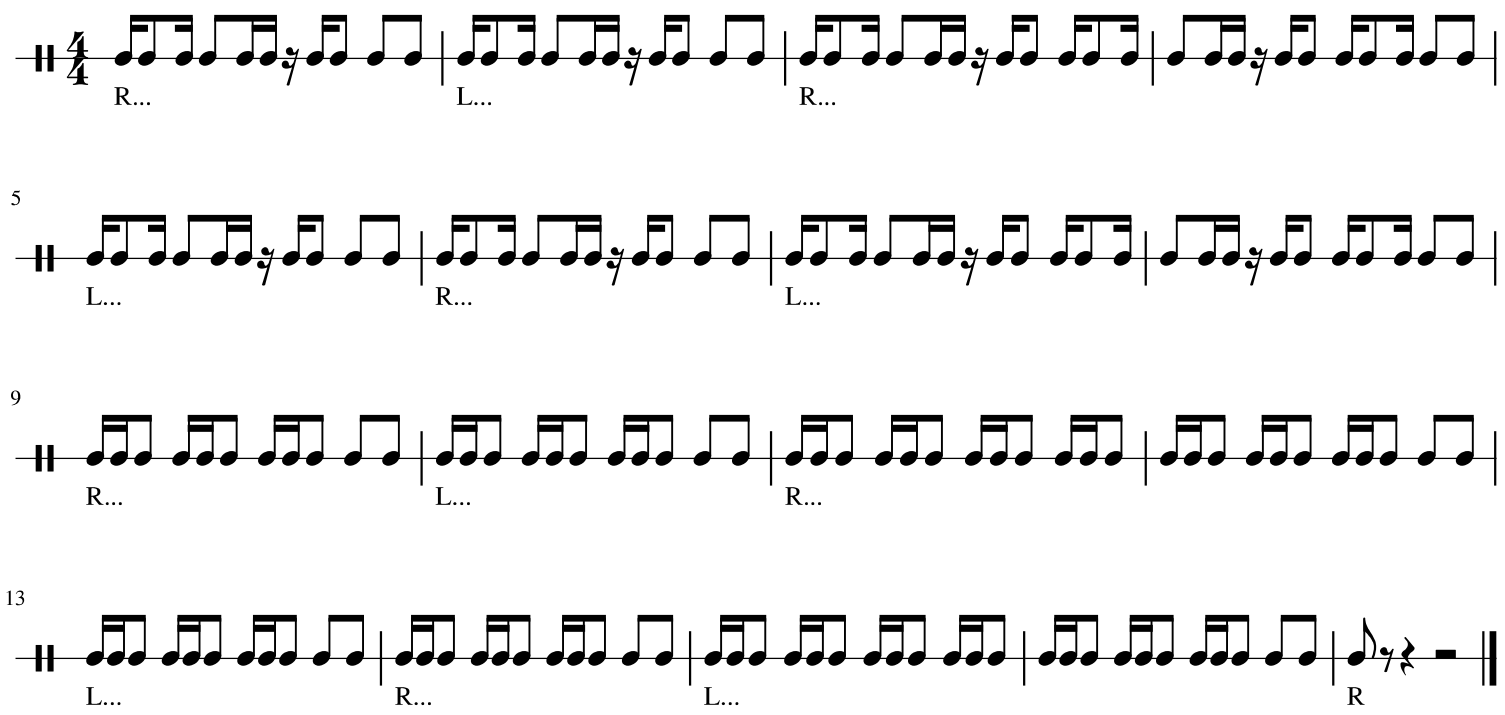


MP Publications © 2014

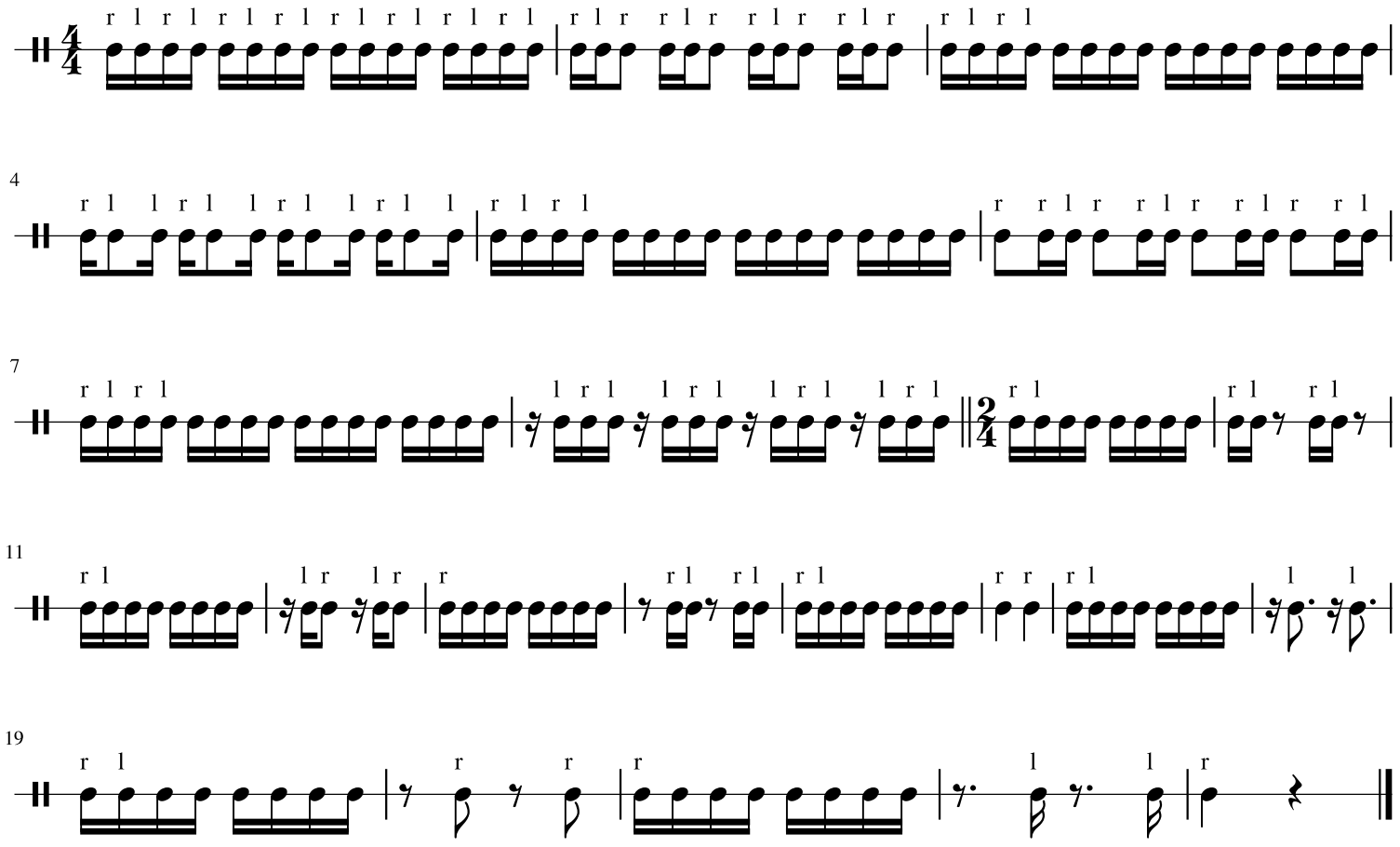
Bucks



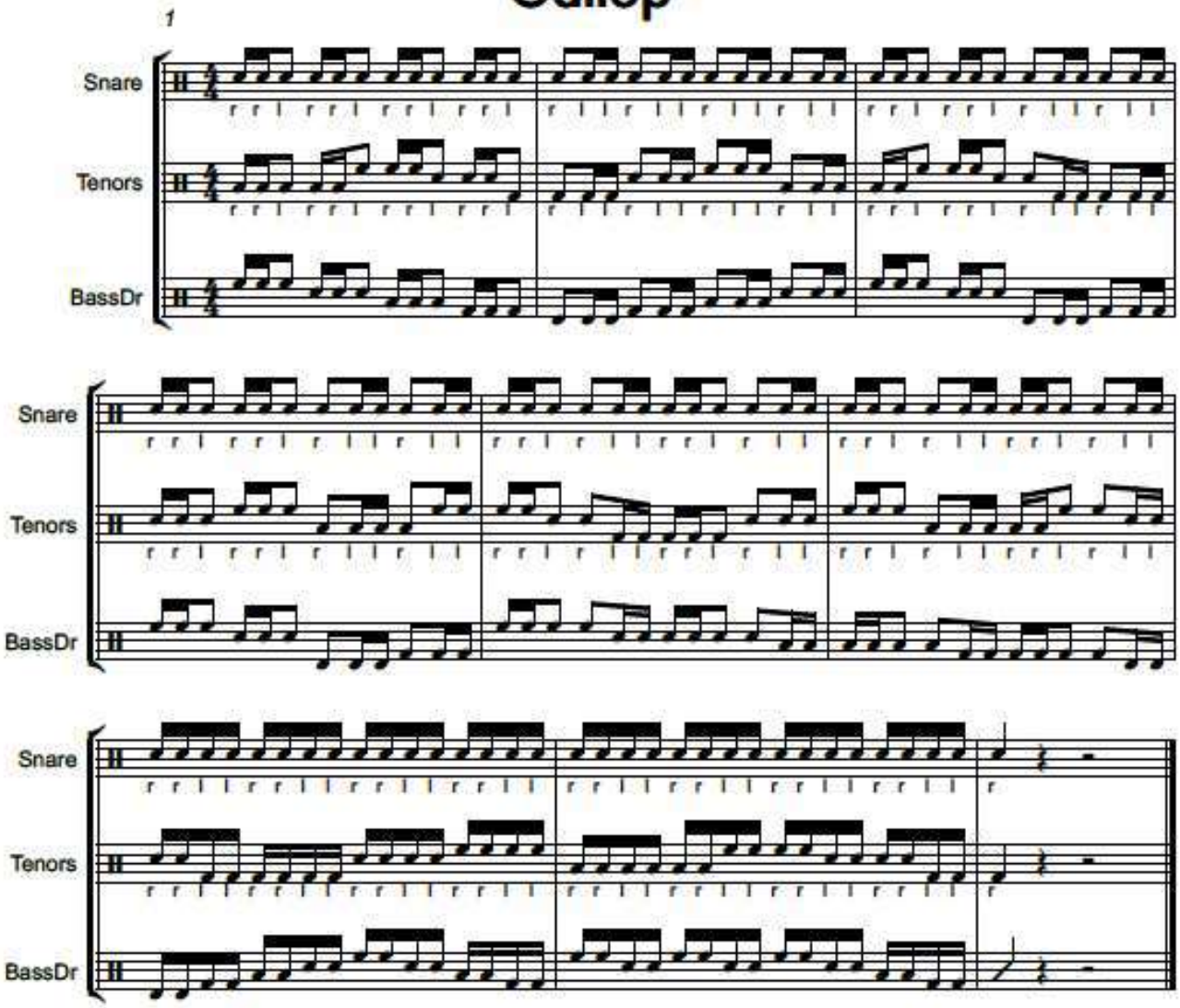
Double/Triple Beat



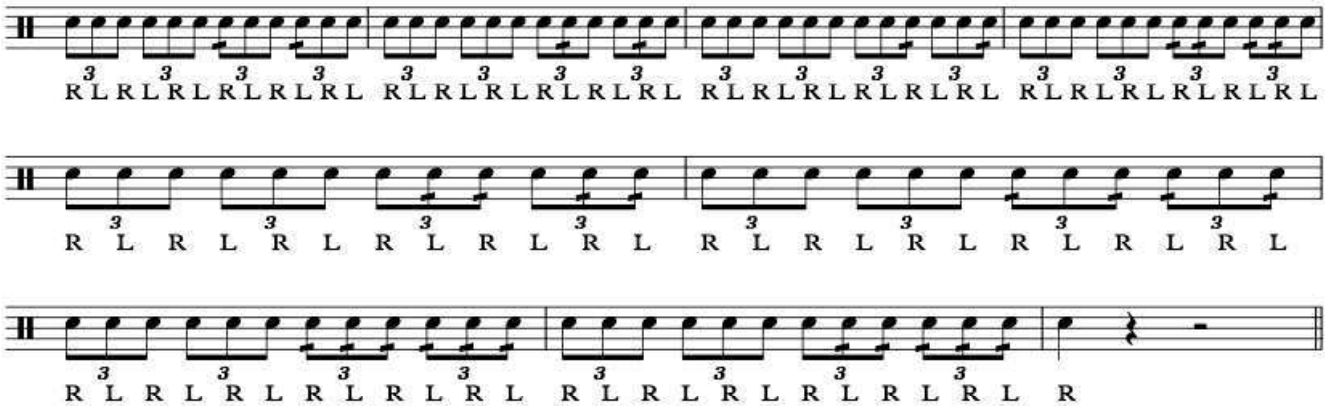
NU 16th Note Timing



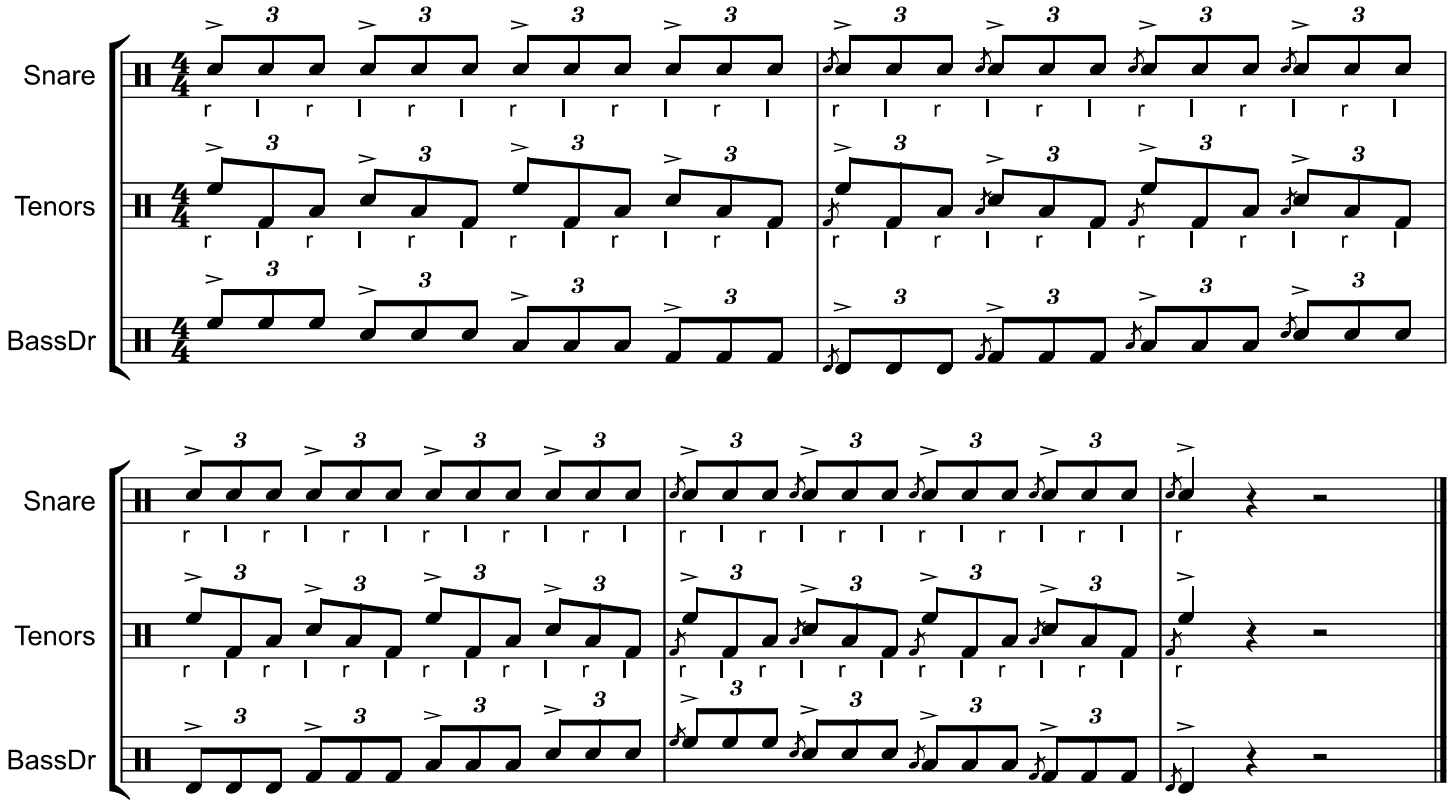
Gallop


1
Snare
Tenors
BassDr
Snare
Tenors
BassDr
Snare
Tenors
BassDr

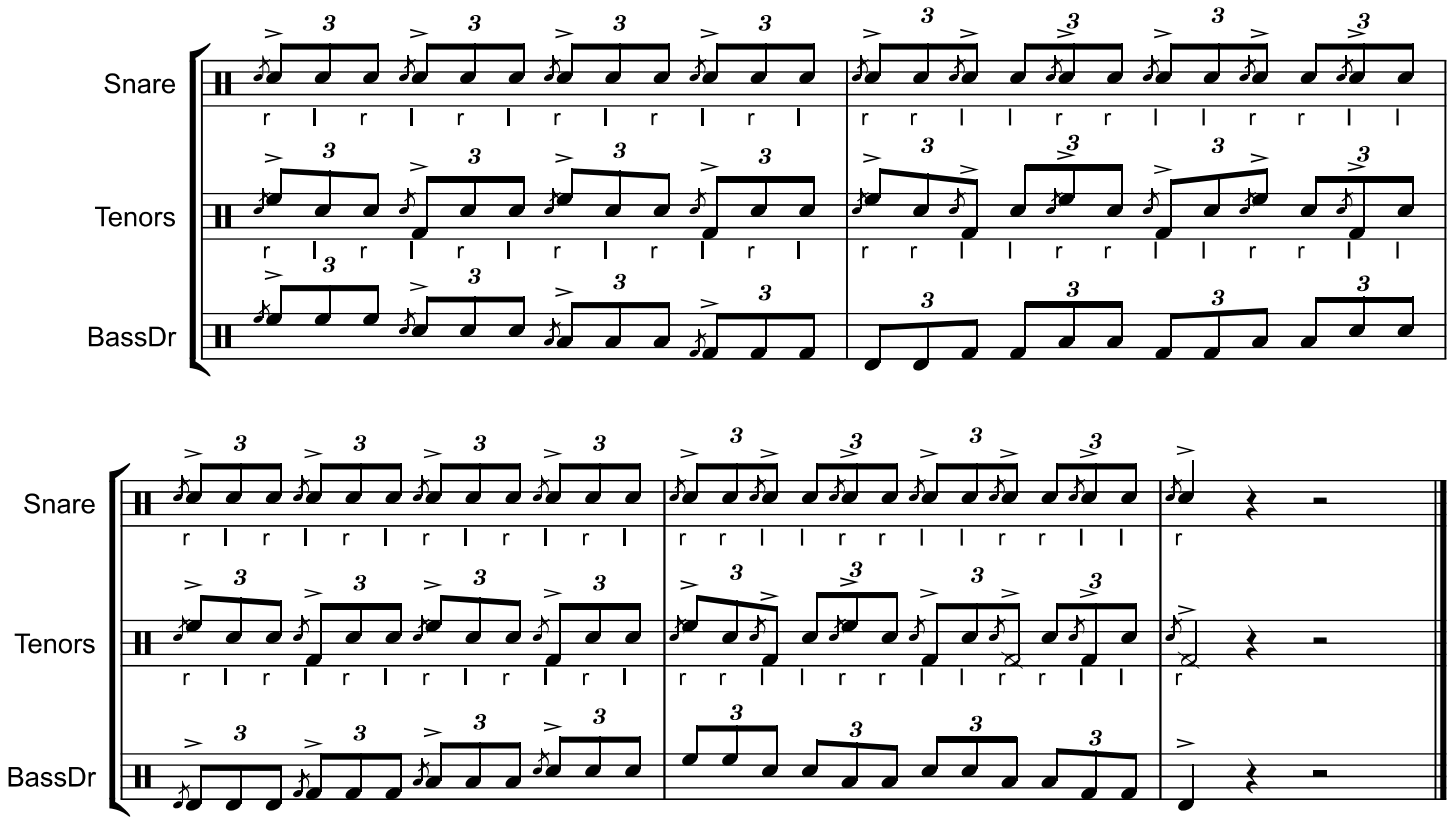
Triplet Diddle


R L R L R L

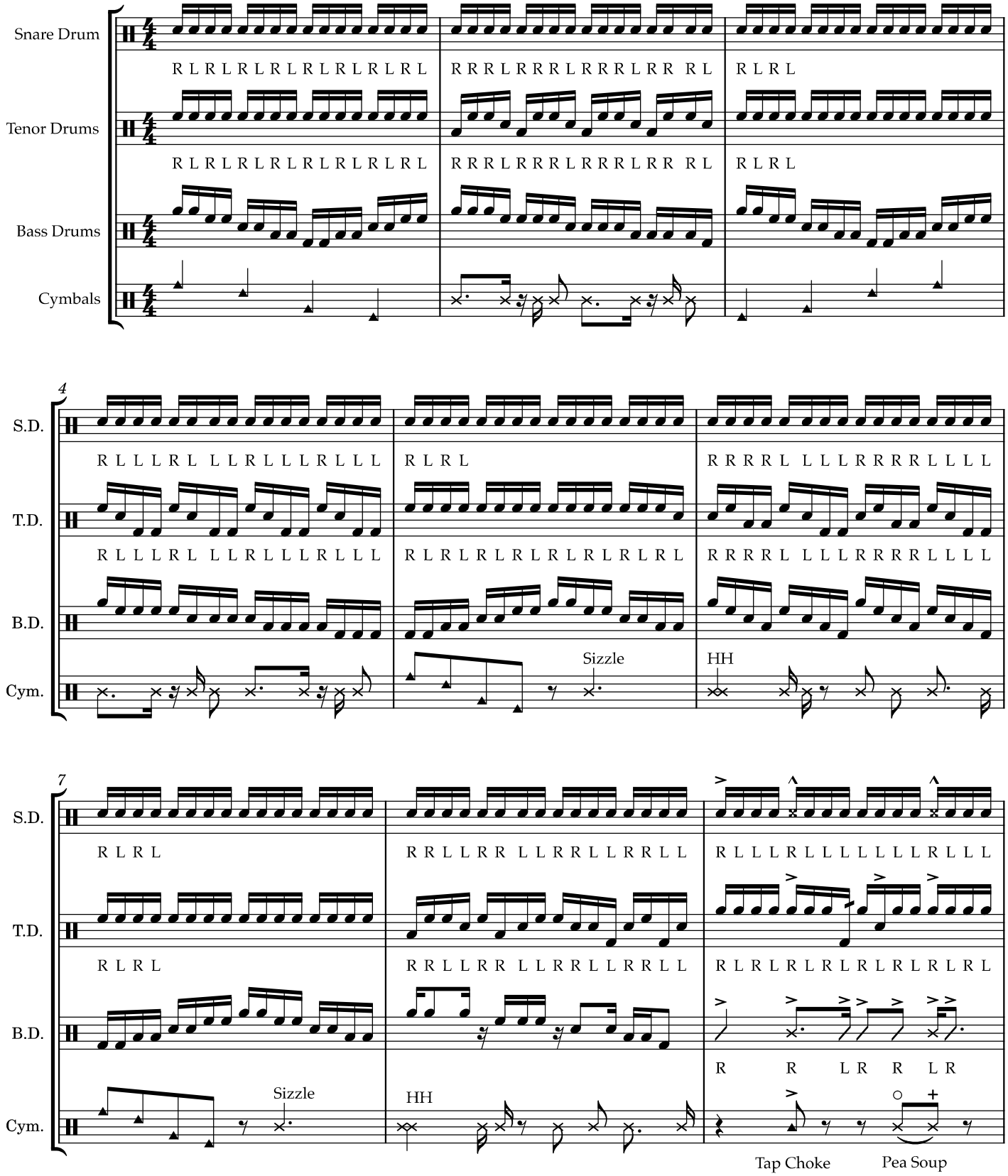
Taps/Flams

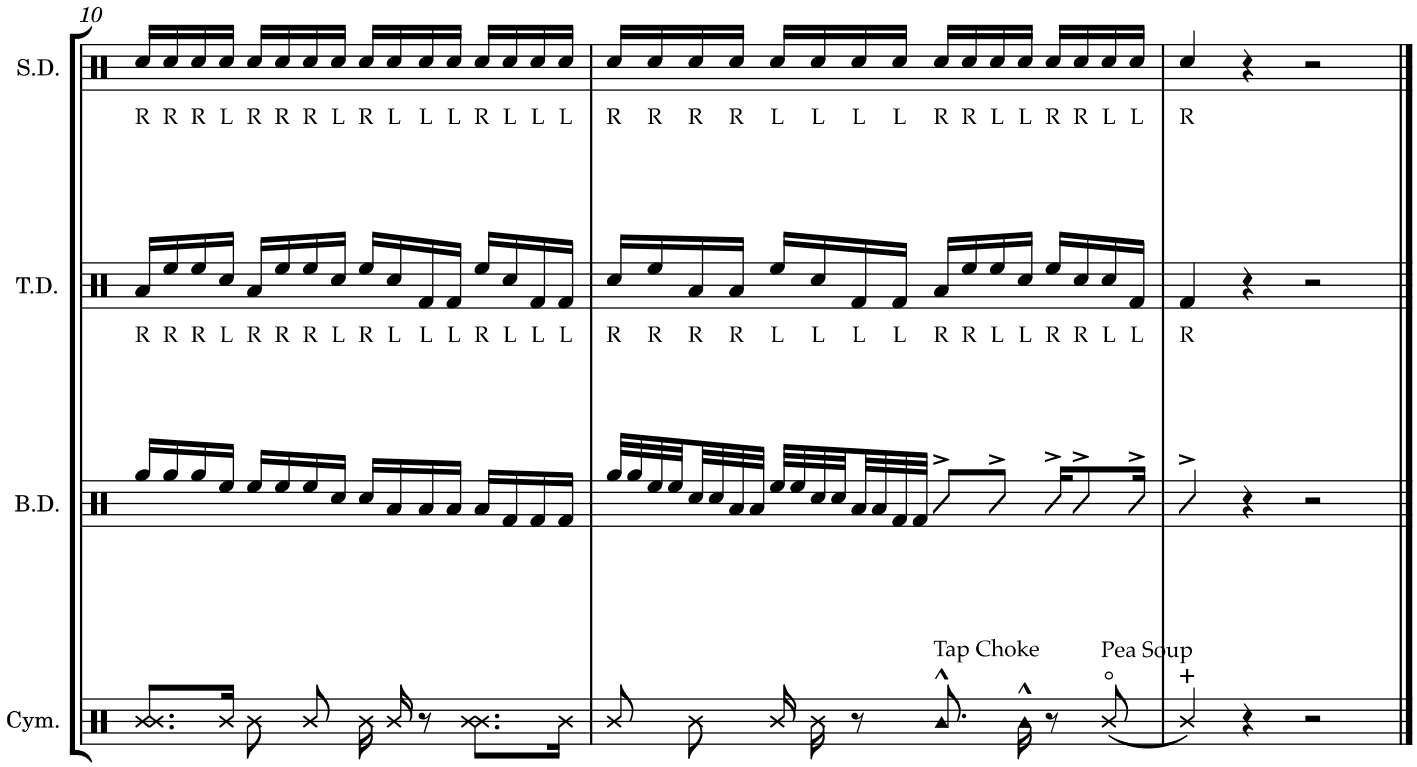


Flams/Flam-Taps

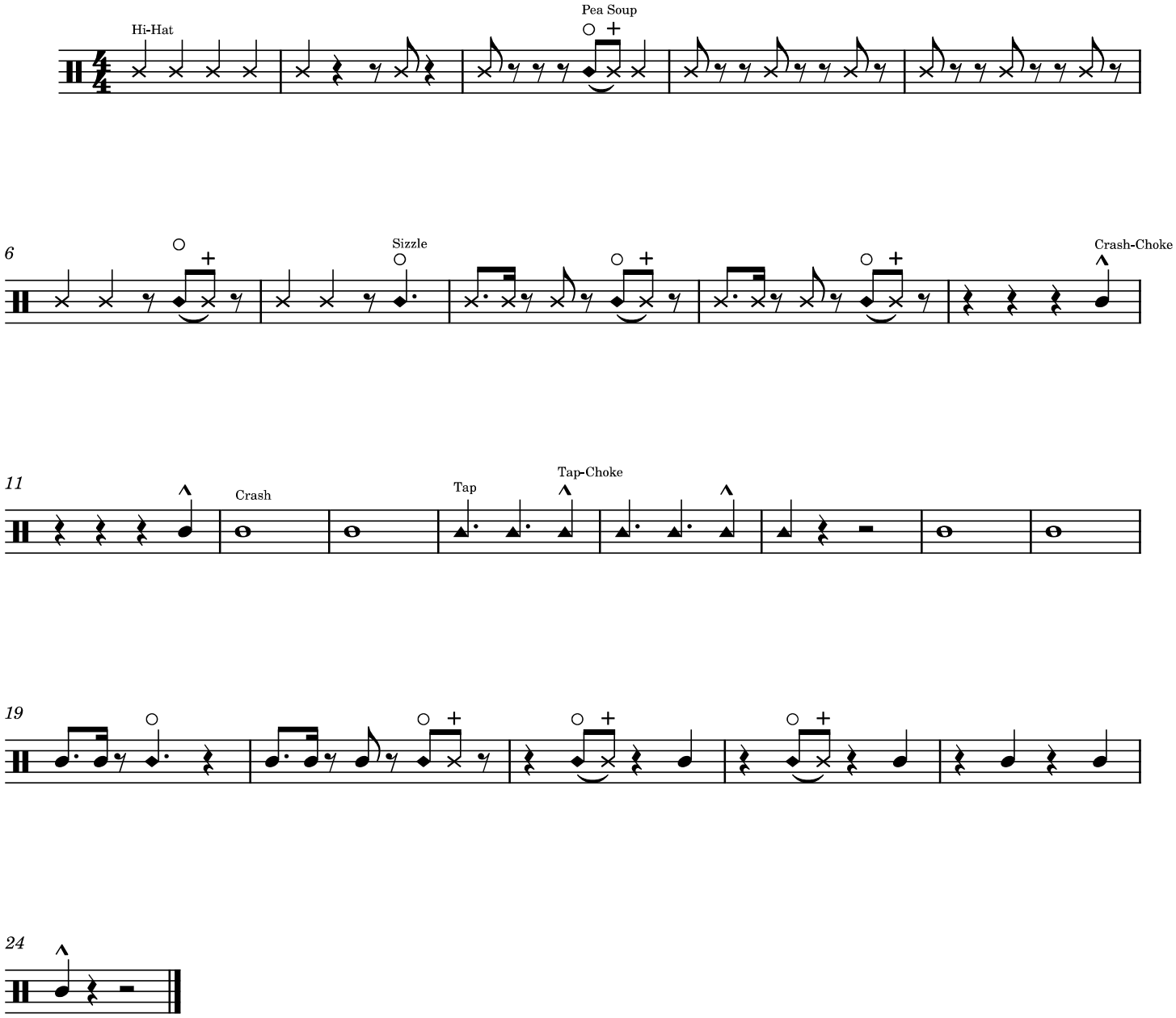


Stick Control




10
S.D.
R R R L R R R L R L L L R L L L R R R R L L L L R R L L R R L L R
T.D.
R R R L R R R L R L L L R L L L R R R R L L L L R R L L R R L L R
B.D.
Cym.
Tap Choke
Pea Soup

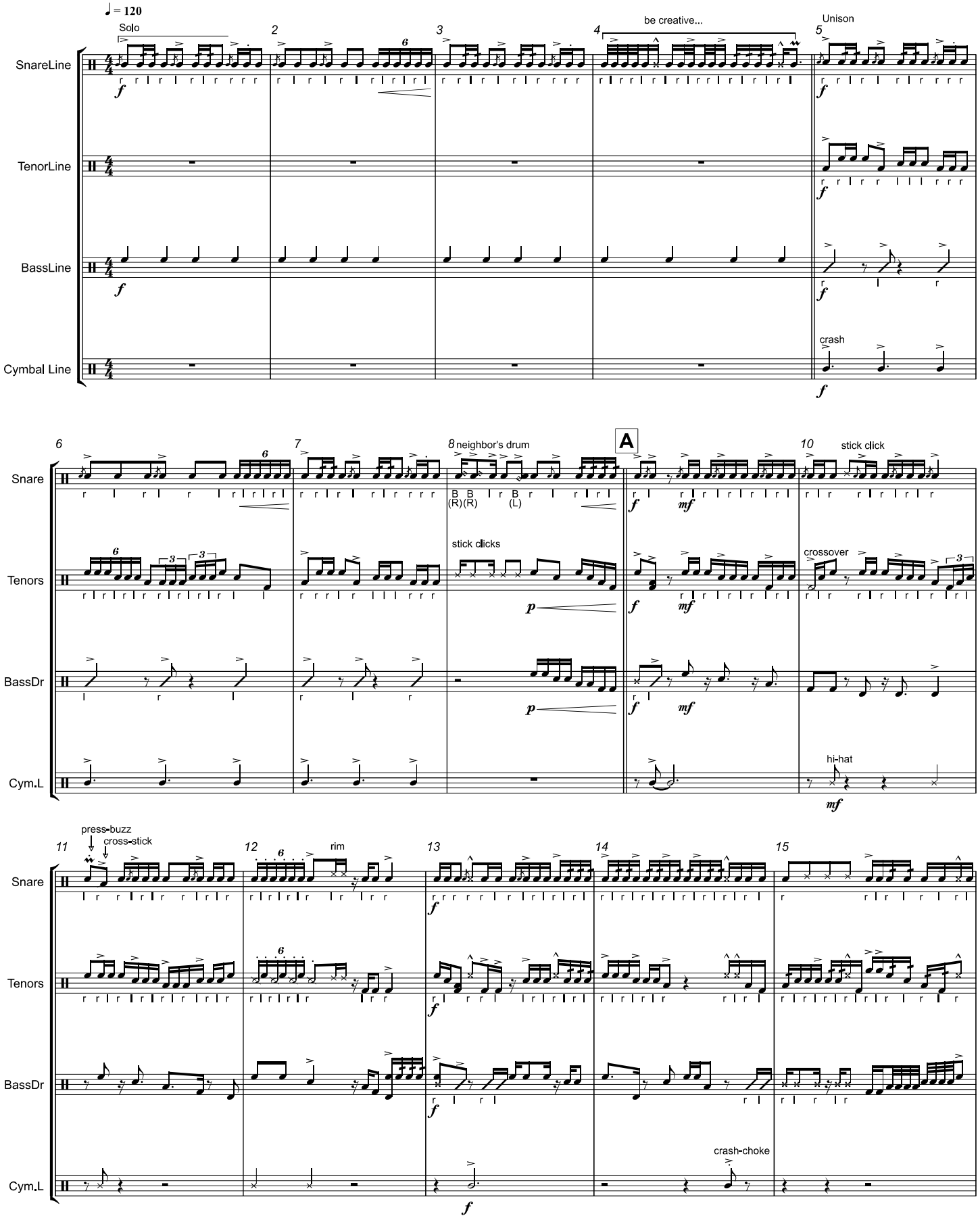
Clave


Hi-Hat
Pea Soup
6
Sizzle
Crash-Choke
11
Crash
Tap
Tap-Choke
19
24

Traditional

2015 NU Drumline

Arr. Matt Penland



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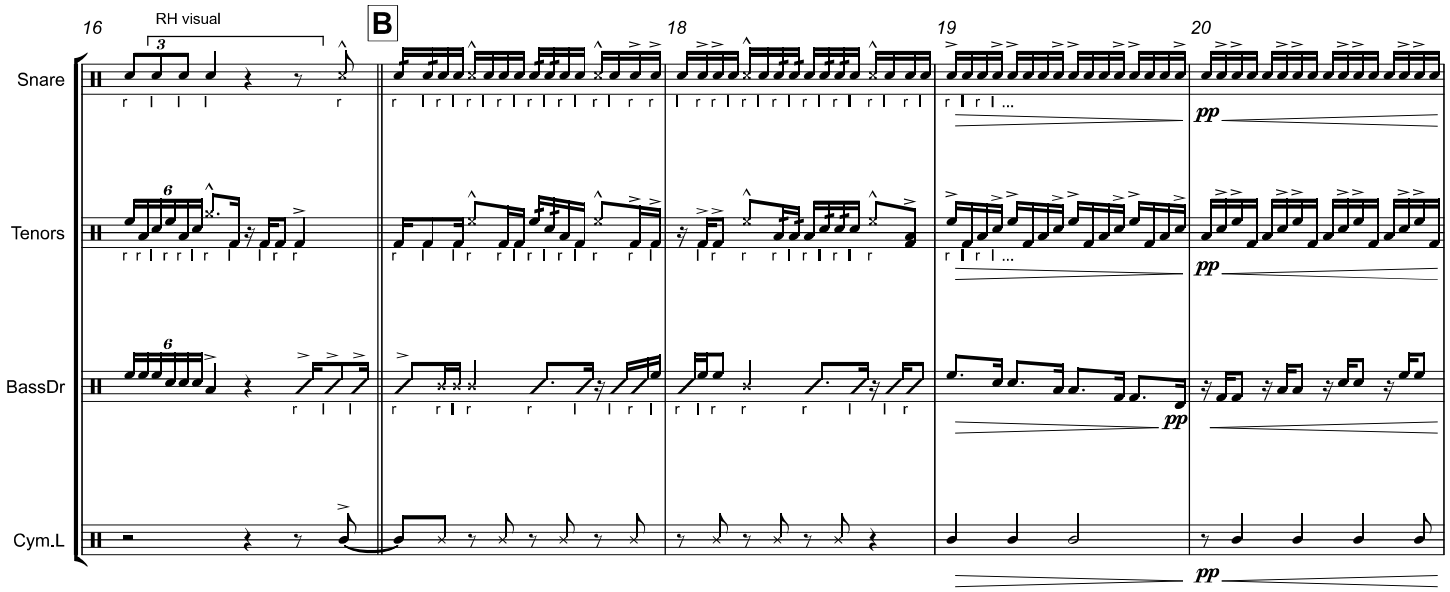
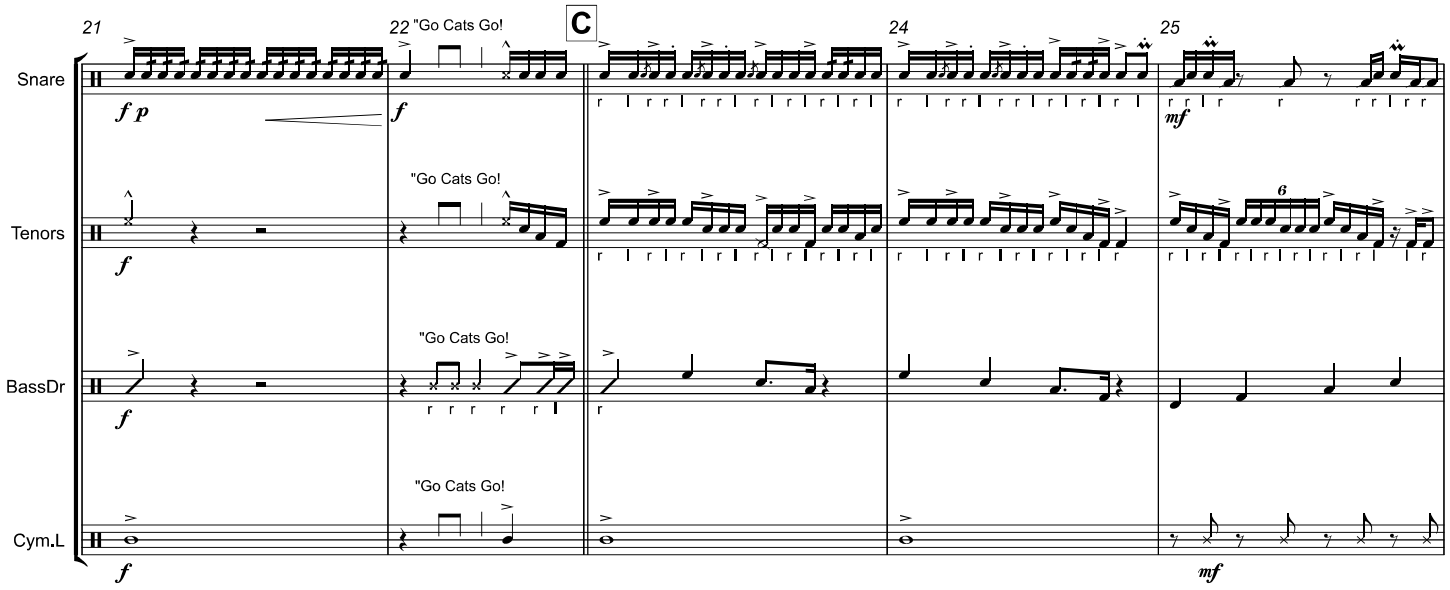
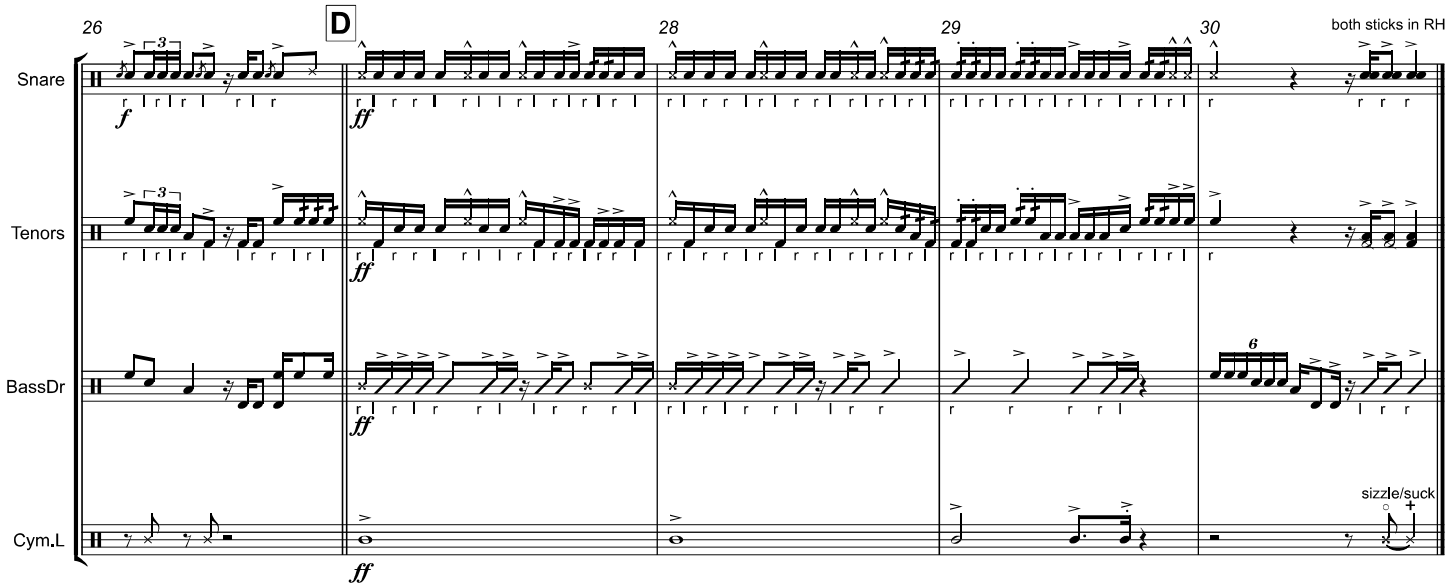

16
RH visual
B
18
19
20
Snare
Tenors
BassDr
Cym.L
pp


21
22
"Go Cats Go!
C
24
25
Snare
Tenors
BassDr
Cym.L
f p
f
mf


26
D
28
29
30
both sticks in RH
Snare
Tenors
BassDr
Cym.L
f
ff
sizzle/suck